2012 Honda Civic EX

$6,500 · 129,000 miles · Private seller · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1625466102698877/

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 8 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$7,332	**$441**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 3 recalls · 456 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$6,500.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$601.25
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$42.25
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$7,331.50
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$2,331.50
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$46.72
Total interest over the loan	$471.61
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$46.72
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 32 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$148.44
Maintenance & repair reserve	$95.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.02
Total per month	$441.18

Running costs without the loan: **$394/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$12,376** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

The 9th-gen (2012-15) Civic with the 1.8L and 5-speed automatic is one of the most dependable cheap commuters; 2012 had cheaper interior trim but no major mechanical problems.

NHTSA data for this model year: 3 recalls · 456 owner complaints (55 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (149), Steering (74), Electrical System (60), Power Train (49), Service Brakes (39), Vehicle Speed Control (38).

Known issues for this model

• A/C compressor / condenser failures

• Engine mount wear

• Takata airbag recall - confirm done

• Valve adjustment due ~100k if never done

Check on this car before buying

• Title in seller's name matches VIN

• Run VIN for open recalls (Takata)

• A/C cold at idle

• Smooth shifts, no vibration at idle in Drive

• Ask for maintenance records

Notes

$6,500 FIRM, 129k mi, automatic, black/grey. CLEAN TITLE IN HAND, paid off, 2 owners, current smog and tags, no warning lights, 'well maintained'. Listed ~2 weeks ago (Rosedale area, Bakersfield).

Best car found in this price search: newest, lowest miles and best MPG of the $5-6.5k group. Price is firm and $500 over the $6k range.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest - message to confirm before going; bring a mechanic or use a Bakersfield shop for a pre-purchase inspection.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.